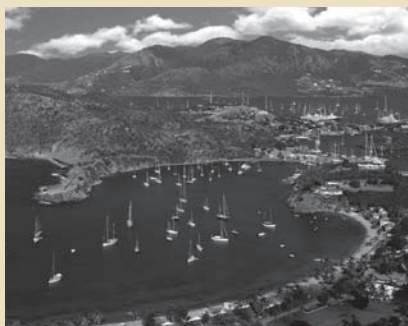




Tourism

Antigua is a popular tourist destination, especially for cruise ships visiting the historic Nelson's Dockyard in English Harbour (above).

1994 **Lester Bird** succeeds his father as prime minister.

2004 **United Progressive Party** takes power for the first time.

2009 **Financial crisis** after Allen Sanford, the island's biggest investor, is charged with fraud.

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St. Kitts & Nevis



These popular tourist destinations lie at the northern end of the Leeward Islands.

1623 **The British first settle** on St. Kitts, and on Nevis in 1628; the islands become a British colony in 1783.

1932 **Pro-independence** St. Kitts-Nevis-Anguilla Labour Party set up.

1967 **Internal self-government.**

1980 **Anguilla formally separates** from St Kitts & Nevis.

1983 **Independence from Britain.**

1998 **Nevis referendum** rejects secession.

Dominica



Small Caribbean island named after Sunday, the day Christopher Columbus first landed there.

1493 **Columbus lands on** Dominica.

1759 **The island is** seized by the British after control has been fiercely contested by British, French, and Caribs in the 17th and 18th centuries. The production of sugar cane is established using slave labor, followed by cotton and coffee.

1805 **Dominica becomes** a British colony.

1951 **Universal suffrage is** introduced.

1958–62 **Dominica is** a member of the West Indies Federation.

1962 **A new constitution** is introduced as Dominica and other Windward Islands achieve separate status.

1967 **Full internal autonomy** as a West Indies Associated State, with Edward Le Blanc as prime minister. UK responsible for defense and foreign relations.

1974 **On his retirement,** Le Blanc is succeeded by Patrick John, who conducts independence negotiations.

1975 **Morne Trois Pitons** national park established.

1978 **Independence from UK.** Patrick John is first prime minister.

1980 **Eugenia Charles,** the Caribbean's first woman prime minister, is elected.

1981 **Two coup attempts,** backed by Patrick John, are foiled.

1995 **Main opposition party** defeats Eugenia Charles, who retires.

2004 **Roosevelt Skerrit** becomes, at 31, the world's youngest serving PM.

2009 **Hurricane Dean** wipes out 90 percent of Dominica's banana crop.

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St. Lucia



Ruled by both France and Britain, St. Lucia retains the character of both countries.

1814 **Ownership of** the island is finally settled in Britain's favor.

1964 **Sugar-growing** ends on the island.

1979 **Gains independence.** Tourist boom.

1990 **Establishes body with** Dominica, Grenada, and St. Vincent to discuss forming a Windward Islands Federation.

2000 **Blacklisted by the** OECD as an international tax haven.

St. Vincent



St. Vincent & the Grenadines lie towards the southern end of the Windward Islands.

1627 **British and French settlers** occupy the islands.

1773 **The Caribs recognize** British rule, but rebel in 1795–7, aided by the French.

1951 **Universal suffrage is** introduced.

1969 **Internal self-government** is achieved.

1979 **Full independence from Britain.** La Soufrière volcano erupts.

1984 **New Democratic Party,** founded by James Mitchell in 1975, wins first of four terms. Mitchell resigns in 2002.

2001 **Unity Labour Party** wins a landslide election victory; Ralph Gonsalves becomes prime minister.

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Barbados



The most easterly of the Windward Islands, Barbados was referred to as "Little England."

1627 **Barbados** becomes English colony.

1800s **Barbados becomes** a prosperous sugar-producing colony with more than 80,000 slaves.

1834 **The abolition of** slavery is a major factor precipitating economic decline.

1951 **Universal adult suffrage** introduced.

1966 **Independence** from Britain.

1983 **Supports and provides** a base for the US invasion of Grenada.

1994–2003 **Barbados Labour Party** wins three successive general elections.

2008 **Democratic Labour Party** under David Thompson wins election.

2009 **Clico, a Trinidad-based** insurance company, collapses, almost toppling Thompson, who dies in office in 2010.

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Grenada



The most southerly Windward Island, Grenada is a major nutmeg producer.

1498 **Columbus visits the** island, which he names Concepción.

1650 **The island is** occupied by forces of the governor of French Martinique.

1674 **French control is** imposed. Sugar mills are established.

1762 **The British take** control and introduce a slave-labor economy producing cotton, cocoa, and nutmeg.

1951 **Universal suffrage** introduced.

1958–62 **Grenada forms part** of the West Indies Federation.

1967 **Internal self-government.**

1974 **Gains independence** from Britain.

1979 **Coup makes** Maurice Bishop prime minister. Growing links with Cuba.

1983 **US invasion** establishes pro-US administration.

1995 **Keith Mitchell** elected prime minister.

2004 **Hurricane Ivan** devastates island.

2008 **Keith Mitchell** loses election in surprise National Democratic party win.

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Trinidad & Tobago



This two-island republic lies very close to the Venezuelan coast of South America.

1498 **Columbus visits** Trinidad and claims both islands for Spain.

1781 **French capture** Tobago.

1799 **Britain seizes** Trinidad and, in 1814, France cedes control over Tobago.

1888 **Trinidad and Tobago** united.

1956 **Eric Williams** founds People's National Movement (PNM) and wins general election with support from Afro-Caribbeans; the minority Asian population supports the opposition.

1958–1961 **Member of** West Indian Federation.

1962 **Independence** from Britain.

1980 **Tobago gets its own** House of Assembly and internal autonomy in 1987.

1995 **Basdeo Panday** becomes the first Asian-origin prime minister.

2010 **Kamla Persad-Bissessar** becomes the first female prime minister.

«280–81 The Slave Trade



Oil wealth

Commercial production of oil began on Trinidad in 1908 and now accounts for 70 percent of export earnings. Gas production is also important.